



▽ Moche stirrup-spout jar

200–300 CE

MOCHE CULTURE REACHES ITS PEAK IN PERU

Moche, the capital of a people of northern coastal Peru, became a centre for innovation and creativity. Its craftsmen produced beautiful gold- and silver-electroplated jewellery and fine stirrup-spout jars. The Temple of the Sun – a huge stepped pyramid – and the elaborate royal tombs at Dos Cabezas reveal a sophisticated and wealthy culture.

212 CE ANTONINE CONSTITUTION

Up to the 3rd century CE, Roman citizenship extended to people in Italy, in Roman colonies, and those rewarded for army service. In 212 CE, Emperor Caracalla extended it to all free adults in the empire. He may have done so to raise money, as citizens were liable to inheritance duties, or to counter his unpopularity, but the measure helped knit the empire together in the decades to come.



△ Roman military tablet granting citizenship

c. 200 CE **The Bakshali manuscript** is the oldest manuscript to contain a sign for zero

200 CE

220–280 CE CHINA'S THREE KINGDOMS

By the 190s CE, the Han dynasty had lost most of its territory to contending warlords. One of these, Cao Cao, reunited the north, but he was defeated in 208 CE during his invasion of southern China at the Battle of the Red Cliffs. From 220 CE China dissolved into the Three Kingdoms of Cao Wei, Shu Han, and Sun Wu, in a period of disunity that lasted for 60 years.

▷ **Cao Cao** gazes at the moon the night before the Battle of the Red Cliffs



161–223 CE
LIU BEI

After serving as a Han general, Liu Bei allied with Cao Cao, but later turned on him during the Red Cliffs campaign in 208 CE, becoming the first ruler of the Three Kingdoms state of Shu Han.